

PHISHING EMAIL ANALYSIS REPORT

1. Email sample details

Sender: security-alert@microsoft-example.test

Displayed name: Microsoft Account Support

Subject :URGENT: your account will be suspended

2. Sender Analysis

The displayed name claims to represent Microsoft, but the sender uses a suspicious domain with altered spelling (microsoft). This is a potential sender impersonation/phishing indicator.

3. subject Analysis

The subject uses urgent and threatening language by saying that the account will be suspended. This may pressure the recipient to act quickly without verifying the email.

4. Email Body Analysis

The email claims that unusual activity was detected and threatens account suspension within 24 hours. It asks the recipient to verify the account immediately and provide account information. These are indicators of social engineering because the message creates fear and urgency to encourage the recipient to act quickly.

6. The email contains a suspicious URL:

<http://microsoft-example.test/verify>. The domain does not match the organization being impersonated and contains altered spelling. This is a potential phishing link. The link was not opened during the analysis.

7. Spelling and Language Analysis

The email uses a generic greeting such as “Dear User” instead of addressing the recipient by name. It also uses suspicious brand spelling in the sender address. These language characteristics can be indicators of phishing, although they are not conclusive on their own.

8. Header Analysis

Raw email headers were not available because this is a simulated training email. Therefore, SPF, DKIM, and DMARC authentication results could not be verified.

9. Phishing Indicators Identified

1. Suspicious sender domain.
2. Altered spelling of the claimed brand name.
3. Urgent and threatening subject line.
4. Account suspension threat.
5. Generic greeting.
6. Request to verify account information.
7. Suspicious URL.
8. Use of fear and urgency as social engineering techniques.

10. Tools Used

The following tools were used during the analysis:

Microsoft Word Online – Report preparation
Notepad – Creation of the simulated email sample
Manual email analysis – Examination of sender, subject, body, and URL

11. Safety Precautions

The email used for this task was a simulated training sample. The suspicious URL was not opened, and no real username, password, or personal information was entered or submitted.

12. Conclusion

The analyzed sample contains several common phishing indicators, including sender impersonation, urgent language, social engineering techniques, and a suspicious URL.

This analysis demonstrates how phishing emails can attempt to create fear and urgency and encourage users to provide sensitive information. Users should verify the sender, inspect links carefully, and avoid providing sensitive information through suspicious emails.